word “Arabs”, but the implication was clear. The next day, he said Israel was facing a “major wave of arson”, calling it “terrorism in every sense of the word”. Shmuel Eliyahu, the chief rabbi of Safed, urged Jewish Israelis to shoot Arabs who were lighting fires, and even gave them special dispensation to do so on Shabbat. *Yediot Aharonot* dubbed it the “intifada of arsons”, a name that spread quickly throughout the media. Channel 2 aired an accusatory video of a Palestinian man standing next to a small fire.

The fires were not limited to Jewish areas, or to Israel. Haifa is a mixed city, and the country’s best example of Jewish-Arab coexistence. A number of Arab villages in the Galilee were evacuated. Dozens of fires broke out across the West Bank, near Ramallah, Hebron and other cities; the Palestinian fire brigade counted more than thirty on Friday alone. And there were fires in neighboring Lebanon, which has a similar climate and topography.

But the hysteria continued, reaching its peak with the case of Anas Abudaabes, a journalist and photographer from the Bedouin town of Rahat. He spoke out against the incitement in a pair of Facebook posts on Thursday. In the first one, written around noon, Abudaabes decried the “ignorance” of his fellow Arabs. “Our country is burning, and it turns out there are Arabs in countries in the region who are busy praising God for this,” he wrote.

A few hours later, he followed up with a second post, outlining some “urgent steps” that Arabs could take to celebrate. The hundreds of thousands of Muslims living near the fires in Haifa and Jerusalem shouldn’t worry, he joked, since “what has happened is from God”—just pour the gasoline “in a direction away from your homes,” and you’ll be fine. He also suggested that “our young thugs” go start fires in “Iqrit, Imwas, Tel al-Khuweilfeh, Asqelon, Bisan, al-Fallujah, al-Tantura and Khabiza.” Any Palestinian would have immediately understood his meaning: none of these villages exist anymore. They were destroyed by the Israeli army during the war of independence. Setting fire to Haifa or Jerusalem, he implied, would be no better than what the Israelis did in 1948. He concluded by reminding his readers that a Muslim leader (Abu Bakr, the first caliph) had given instructions to soldiers not to uproot or burn palm trees. In case it still wasn’t clear, Abudaabes added a “sarcasm, not serious” hashtag to the bottom of his post.